



You can, with a little work, import your contacts into Gmail

dragging it down the list. Hold down [Ctrl] + [C] to copy the list. Open Microsoft Excel (or a similar spreadsheet program that supports comma separated values).

Select cell A1 in Excel. Hold down [Ctrl] + [V] to paste (don't use 'Paste Special'). Choose 'Save As' from the 'File' menu, and select the type 'CSV (Comma delimited)'. Make a note of where you saved the file.

Using Mozilla Or Firefox:

Sign into your Hotmail account. Click the 'Contacts' tab. Click 'Print view'. Align the cursor with the first letter of the 'Name' column. Highlight your contacts by holding down the cursor and dragging it down the list.

Hold down [Ctrl] + [C] to copy the list. Now, open either Microsoft Excel or a similar spreadsheet program that supports comma separated values.

Next, select cell A1 in Excel. Right-click inside cell A1 and select 'Paste Special'. Select 'Text', and click 'OK'. Choose 'Save As' from the 'File' menu, and select the type 'CSV (Comma delimited)'. Make a note of where you saved the file.

To Export A CSV File From Outlook And Outlook Express:

Here are some general directions to follow, though instructions may vary by version. For more detailed instructions, open 'Help' in Outlook or Outlook Express and type 'export' in the search box. Look for topics including 'export wizard', 'export information', 'exporting contacts' or

'exporting address book contacts' in the title.

From Outlook:

Select **File > Import/Export > Export** from the main menu. Choose **Comma Separated Values (Windows)**. Select 'Contacts', and save the exported file.

From Outlook Express:

Select **File > Export > Address Book** from the main menu. Select 'Text File' (Comma Separated Values). Next, click 'Export'.

Importing A CSV File Into Gmail:

Log into Gmail and click 'Contacts' on the left side of the page. The Contacts list then opens in a new window. Click 'Import Contacts'. Click 'Browse' and locate the CSV file you'd like to upload. Select the file and click 'Import Contacts'. After successfully uploading the document, a dialog box displays the number of new entries that were added to your Contacts list.

An Easy Way To Import Contacts

There is a super-easy way to add your existing address book from your old e-mail account (Yahoo, Hotmail, or any other) to your Gmail contacts list.

Here's what to do: first e-mail everyone on your list including yourself at your new Gmail address. Say something like: "I'm going to be switching e-mail addresses to my new Gmail account." Then, 'Reply All' to that e-mail from your Gmail account. Tell everybody, "This is my new Gmail account."

Everybody you e-mailed will then be in your Gmail contacts list.

Use '+' to separate mails

Gmail filters can separate mails sent to name+someword@gmail.com and name+anotherword@gmail.com. For example, give your Gmail address to Amazon and eBay as name+amazon@gmail.com and name+ebay@gmail.com respectively, and then you'll be able to filter the mails from Amazon and eBay.

Selecting Many Mails At Once

Suppose you have many mails to select (say for archiving them). In Gmail, select the first mail, press [Shift] and select the last mail. All mails between the first and the last will be selected, just like in ordinary desktop applications.

The Gmail Notifier

The Gmail Notifier is a downloadable Windows application that alerts you when you have new Gmail messages. It displays an icon in your system tray to let you know if you have unread Gmail messages, and shows you their subjects, senders and snippets, all without your having to open a Web browser. Download it at <http://snipurl.com/gefx>

Use Gmail As Your Default Mail Client

G-Mailto is a utility that automatically associates "mailto" e-mail links on the Web with Gmail. So clicking an e-mail link will open the Gmail compose window instead of opening, say, Outlook Express, that doesn't work with Gmail (yet). If you are not logged in, it will bring you to the Gmail login screen and redirect you to the compose window after you log in. Download the utility here: <http://snipurl.com/geg5>

All About Labels

Gmail lets you assign a Label to a message and then view all messages assigned to that Label. Sounds a lot like the typical

'Folder', but unlike Folders, you can assign multiple Labels to a message, thus letting the message span multiple categories.

To better understand how Labels differ from Folders, consider the real-world counterparts, and it should become clear.

Say, you have a desk full of paper messages, some messages are from family members, and some are jokes that your friends have sent you. Using the Folder model to categorise the messages, you would create one folder called 'Family' and one called 'Jokes'. You would then look through the paper messages and file them accordingly.

When you want to look for a message from your father, you just look in the 'Family' folder. But what if one of the messages is from your mother, and it's a joke or a forward? Which folder do you file it in?

Now, instead of having folders, say, you have sheets of labels, some marked 'Family' and some marked 'Jokes'. You affix 'Family' labels to all messages from your family, and you affix 'Jokes' labels to all messages that are jokes.

Your mother's message now has two labels on it. When you want to see all Family messages, you just look at all the messages that have 'Family' labels. Some may also have 'Jokes' labels, but you don't care because you are interested in your Family messages.

Likewise, when you grab all the messages labelled 'Jokes', some may also have 'Family' labels, but again, you don't care because you are looking at Jokes. Further, if you only want to look at jokes from your family, you look at the messages with both 'Family' and 'Jokes' labels.

But Gmail lets you assign multiple labels to a message! So just put one or more Labels on a message, and finding it later becomes much easier. You can add a Label to a message in one of two ways:

☐ If you are viewing a message listing, you can just